ASA Section on Statistics and the Environment

ASA Section on Statistics and the Environment Newsletter
Winter Edition 2026
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Message from Outgoing ENVR Chair

Dear ENVR Section Members,

As 2025 comes to a close, I would like to share how much of a privilege it has been to serve as Chair of the ENVR Section. This year brought many opportunities to learn from one another, form new collaborations, and strengthen the role of rigorous statistical methods in environmental science. I have been continually impressed by the generosity and dedication of our members, and I am deeply grateful for the many ways you support the work of the Section. Our time at JSM in Nashville was a particular highlight, with engaging invited and contributed sessions and a Student Paper Competition that showcased the talent of emerging statisticians.

I would like to sincerely thank the ENVR Executive Committee for their substantial time and effort throughout the year. The Section runs smoothly because of the thoughtful work taking place behind the scenes. I am especially thankful for the guidance of William Christensen (2025 Past Chair) and for the leadership and vision of Peter Craigmile as our incoming 2026 Chair. Looking ahead, I am excited about plans for the next ENVR Workshop, which will take place in Houston at the University of Houston main campus on October 8–10, 2026. An excellent organizing committee is already in place, and more details will be shared soon. I hope you will mark your calendars and plan to join us.

Serving this community has been deeply rewarding, and I have greatly enjoyed working with colleagues I respect and admire. As we move into the new year, I hope we will continue to advance sound statistical practice in environmental science while mentoring the next generation of environmental statisticians.

Wishing you all a joyful and productive 2026.

Mikyoung Jun
ENVR Chair, 2025

Message from Incoming ENVR Chair

Dear ENVR Section Members,
Happy New Year!

I am honored to be starting as the Chair of the Section on Statistics and the Environment (ENVR). I have long felt that the ENVR community is a wonderful collection of people, bound together by a common interest to apply good statistical practice to the many facets of the environment. You all contribute to making this ASA section successful.

I would like to thank Mikyoung Jun as well as previous section chairs for their guidance and leadership. I also express my gratitude to the executive board who work tirelessly to support the section.

I hope that you take advantage of all the opportunities this year including at the Joint Statistical Meetings (JSM) in Boston and the ENVR workshop in Houston in October. Please be mindful of ASA and ENVR deadlines for submitting JSM abstracts, award nominations, and opportunities to get more involved in the section and ASA -- many appear in this newsletter.

Have a wonderful year, and I look forward to seeing and hearing from you soon.

Peter Craigmile
2026 ENVR Chair

JSM 2025 Debrief

JSM 2025 was held in Nashville, Tennessee, and it was another successful year for the ENVR community. Thanks to the efforts of the organizers and participants, ENVR featured a strong scientific program, including 5 invited sessions, 4 topic contributed sessions, 6 contributed sessions, and 1 poster session. ENVR continued its commitment to supporting junior statisticians and data scientists through the annual ENVR Mentoring Roundtable and the ENVR Student Paper Competition. We look forward to seeing you again at JSM 2026 in Boston.

Abhirup Datta
2025 JSM Program Chair

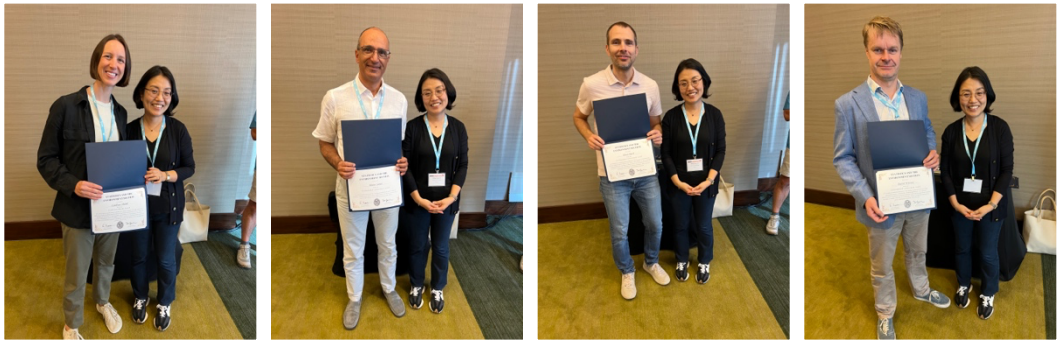

Figure 1: From left to right: ENVR Early Investigator Awardee, Lyndsay Shand; three of the ENVR Distinguished Achievement Award recipients Bruno Sanso, Brian Reich and David Warton.

Figure 2: ENVR Student Paper Award winners (from left to right): Kevin Collins and Shuren He

Save the Date! 2026 ENVR Workshop

The 2026 ENVR Workshop will take place October 8–10, 2026 in Houston, TX. Save the date! More information will be available at

Upcoming ENVR Award Nominations

Every year ENVR solicits nominations for the ENVR Distinguished Achievement Award (DAA) (formerly, Distinguished Achievement Medal) and the ENVR Early Investigator Award (EIA) (formerly called the Young Investigator Award). Both are given in recognition of outstanding contributions to the development of methods, issues, concepts, applications, and initiatives in environmental statistics. The section uses a broad definition of environmental statistics--from theoretical/foundational through applications and policy--and seeks to recognize the full range of activities that academic, governmental, and industrial statisticians and scientists study in statistics and the environment. Environmental statistics is interdisciplinary, and outstanding contributions may occur outside of traditional disciplinary niches.

The upcoming award nominations will be announced in early 2026 with a due date in Spring 2026. As you think of your colleagues to nominate, refer to the nomination criteria as a guide.

2026 Elected Officers (ENVR Executive Board)

Chair: Peter Craigmile, Hunter College, CUNY
Past Chair: Mikyoung Jun, University of Houston
Chair-Elect: Mark Risser*, Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory
Secretary: Pulong Ma, Iowa State University
Treasurer: Michael Dumelle*, U.S. Environmental Protection Agency
Publications Chair: Ander Wilson, Colorado State University
Publications Chair-Elect: Josh North*, Lawrence Berkeley National Laboratory
Program Chair: Lyndsay Shand, Sandia National Laboratories
Program Chair-Elect: Whitney Huang*, Clemson University
COS Rep (2024-2026): Ali Arab, The Georgetown University

* Newly elected